Ali Demir

Economist | Applied Microeconomics

ali-demir.org | Ali.Demir-l1f@ruhr-uni-bochum.de | linkedin.com/in/alid3mir

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Migration, Labor and Demographic Economics.
Secondary: Housing and Regional Economics.

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics *2023–2026*
Ruhr University Bochum, Germany

- Dissertation: *Essays in Empirical Family and Regional Economics. (Magna Cum Laude)*
- Advisors: Thomas K. Bauer and Arnaud Chevalier.

MSc in Behavioral and Applied Economics *2021–2023*
University of Trento, Italy

- Exchange Year (Erasmus+) in Public Economics, Freie Universität Berlin, Germany.
- Research Visit, Host: Susann Fiedler at Vienna University of Economics and Business, Austria.

BSc in Mathematics *2016–2021*
Middle East Technical University, Ankara, Turkey

JOB MARKET PAPER

German Internal Migration: A Marriage Market Perspective. Investigates whether young East–West migration after German reunification altered marriage formation and marital stability in receiving West German districts. Assembles an original harmonized district panel of vital and court statistics over 1985–2007 (extending to 1980/1982 for balanced sub-panels) with observed cumulative young-adult arrivals (aged 18–29) from 1991 onward, scaled by fixed pre-reunification population. Instruments migration exposure using a shift-share design interacting pre-Berlin Wall (1961 census) East-linked settlement shares with settlement share by the cumulative rate of young-adult arrivals from East Germany, calculated across sample districts in the other West German states. Preferred estimates show that districts receiving one additional young arrival per 1,000 residents experienced 0.027 fewer annual divorces per 1,000 residents, while the corresponding marriage estimate is statistically imprecise. Balanced event studies extending to 1980 reject differential pre-trends, newly digitized regional accounts (1989–2007) show that more exposed districts within states did not experience faster post-reunification income growth, and initiator decompositions detect no significant asymmetry between wife- and husband-initiated divorces. The results reject partner-market thickness and sex-ratio bargaining explanations, pointing instead to rising household transition costs or residential sorting.

WORKING PAPERS

Housing Security and Family Expansion: Evidence from German Homeownership. Estimates the effect of homeownership on fertility among West German women, using SOEP-Core panel data with district and year fixed effects and parental homeownership as an instrument. Homeownership significantly accelerates the transition from first to second birth. The estimate for the cumulative number of children is small and statistically indistinguishable from zero, consistent with a tempo effect on the timing of second births; effects on completed family size remain open. Estimates are local to women whose ownership depends on their parents' ownership, and inference is robust to weak instruments.

Transition to Adulthood: Local Rents and Leaving the Parental Home. Links SOEP-Core residence histories to RWI-GEO-REDX quality-adjusted rent indices at the parental-home postal code to study young adults' first exit from the parental home, with heterogeneity by migration background. Across locations, higher rents predict earlier exit, consistent with high-rent areas being opportunity-rich. Within postal codes over time, the rent gradient turns weakly negative and imprecise; bounds rule out large affordability effects, and lead–lag placebo tests attribute part of the remaining gradient to local trends rather than rents.

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Associate (Wissenschaftlicher Mitarbeiter) *Oct 2023–Sep 2026*
Ruhr University Bochum, Chair of Empirical Economics

- DFG Research Training Group 2484, "Regional Disparities and Economic Policy."
- Course administration for Econometric Evaluation of Economic Policies.

Research Intern *Jul 2022–Oct 2022*
Vienna University of Economics and Business, Institute for Cognition and Behavior

- Designed and implemented an oTree bargaining experiment on overconfidence, prosociality and motivated beliefs. Its data form the basis of the MSc thesis.

Student Research Assistant to Constantinos Hadjichristidis *Jan 2022–Aug 2022*
University of Trento, Department of Economics and Management

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor / Course Designer: Introductory Migration Economics *Winter Semester 2025/26*
Ruhr University Bochum, Chair of Empirical Economics

- Designed an English-language bachelor-level seminar with lecture material on migration definitions, migrant selection, Roy model intuition, integration and human capital, Chiswick–Borjas earnings assimilation, empirical designs and labor-market effects.

Thesis Supervision *2023-2026*
Ruhr University Bochum, Chair of Empirical Economics

- Co-supervised BSc and MSc theses.

CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS

European Network for Housing Research (ENHR) Annual Conference July 2025

RTG 2484 Internal Retreats 2024-2026

SKILLS

Data	SOEP-Core; RWI-GEO-REDX; FDZ secure-enclave workflows; BBSR/INKAR; OCR-assisted digitization of historical regional statistics.
Software	Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, oTree.
Languages	Turkish (Native), English (Fluent), German (Intermediate), Italian (Elementary).

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Assistant Editor *Jan 2022–Oct 2023*
behavioraleconomics.com, remote (UK)

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

University of Trento Merit Scholarship, 2021–2023; Erasmus+ Mobility Grant, 2022–2023; METU Alumni Association Merit Scholarship, 2016–2019; Honor Roll, Middle East Technical University, 2016–2017.

REFERENCES

Thomas K. Bauer
Chair of Empirical Economics
Ruhr University Bochum
RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research
Thomas.Bauer@rub.de

Arnaud Chevalier
Department of Economics
Royal Holloway, University of London
arnaud.chevalier@rhul.ac.uk

Tobias Seidel
Mercator School of Management
University of Duisburg-Essen
tobias.seidel@uni-due.de